RIYADH · DAMMAM · SAUDI ARABIA

21 OCTOBER 2026

Saudi Airports Status

Incident summary and airport deep dives · as of 5:53 PM, Wednesday 21 October 2026, Riyadh time (UTC+3)

Riyadh airport **Halted** · 267 cancelled today | Dammam airport **Disrupted** · 57 cancelled

Riyadh airport halted since 9:29 PM Sunday 11 Oct, 14,191 minutes at 6:00 PM (no takeoff or landing since 3:00 PM); Dammam moving, no halt since 5:59 AM

INCIDENT SUMMARY

1 What is happening now, at both airports and across the Kingdom.

HEADLINE

- **Riyadh airport halted since 9:29 PM Sunday 11 Oct, 14,191 minutes at 6:00 PM; NOTAM A3650/26 still requires prior GACA permission for every flight**.
- No takeoffs or landings on the Riyadh boards since the 3:00 PM edition; 267 Wednesday Riyadh flights cancelled (42%).
- AP says Saudia and flynas flew limited domestic flights today, but our boards don't show it; the airport's own account gave no reopening date at 4:58 PM.
- No new attack, interception or Civil Defense attack warning since 3:00 PM; Macron arrived in Riyadh and met the Crown Prince.
- Dammam airport moving with no halt since 5:59 AM; 6 takeoffs and 5 landings since 3:00 PM, latest Air Arabia G9168 to Sharjah at 5:36 PM.

RIYADH AIRPORT RUH

HALTED

No takeoff or landing since 9:29 PM (14184 min).

267	0/0	6
CANCELLED TODAY	TAKEOFFS/LANDINGS, 1H	DIVERTED

DAMMAM AIRPORT DMM

DISRUPTED

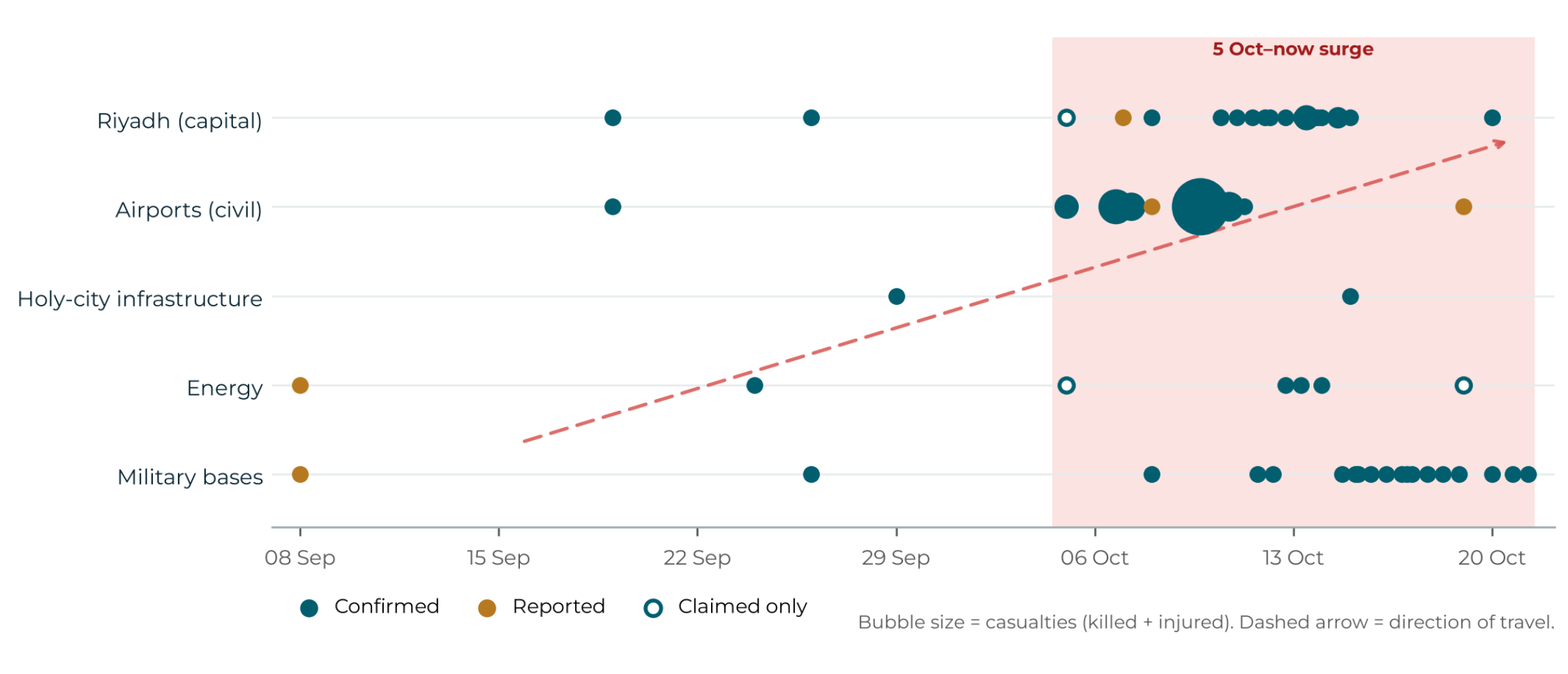
1 takeoff and 1 landing in the last hour.

57	1/1	0
CANCELLED TODAY	TAKEOFFS/LANDINGS, 1H	DIVERTED

WHAT CHANGED IN THE LAST HOUR

- Riyadh still halted since 9:29 PM Sunday 11 Oct (13,830 min at 12:00 PM); no takeoffs or landings since the 9:00 AM edition
- No new attack, interception or Civil Defense alert reported in Saudi Arabia since 9:00 AM
- Yemen's central bank in Aden ordered assets of 135 Houthi-linked people, entities and ships frozen (10:28 AM)
- Iran says Saudi Arabia has not answered its offer to mediate with the Houthis (Al Arabiya English, 10:01 AM; claim)
- Dammam moving with no halt; 9 takeoffs and 9 landings since 9:00 AM

ESCALATION PATTERN: HOUTHI STRIKES ON KSA BY TARGET TYPE, 8 SEP – 21 OCT



56 sourced events since 8 September (48 confirmed). Latest: Coalition: a drone launched toward the Eastern Region intercepted and destroyed; target not stated, no damage or casualties reported (21 Oct, Coalition spokesman (@CJFCSpox) / SPA; none reported). Each event has a source link in strikes.json and on the website. Filled = confirmed officially; amber = reported by credible media; hollow = claimed only (Houthi or unattributed). Events without a source are not plotted.

SO WHAT

The campaign has climbed an escalation ladder: from military targets to economic targets (Aramco, Yanbu), then to symbolic targets (the Madinah power station serving the Prophet’s Mosque), and now to civilian aviation and the capital. King Khalid International Airport has been hit or targeted on 19 Sep, 5, 7, 8, 10 and 11 Oct; the 10–11 Oct strikes closed it indefinitely. On the evening of 11 Oct GACA confirmed a further attack on Dammam’s King Fahd International Airport. Each rung raises the reputational cost to the Kingdom more than the military cost.

ATTACKS, INTERCEPTIONS & ALERTS (KSA-WIDE)

2 Every attack, interception, Civil Defense alert and all-clear, debris fall and casualty report since 3:00 PM.

Sources: Coalition spokesman, SPA, Civil Defense, Interior and Energy ministries, Al Ekhbariya, Reuters/AP. Riyadh time.

No new attacks, interceptions or alerts since 3:00 PM AST.

Last 24 hours: Interceptions 2.

NEWS AND STATEMENTS

3 Riyadh still halted; Macron in Riyadh; airport gives no reopening date; Dammam moving

Checked at 5:56 PM: Reuters, AP, AFP, Arab News, SPA, GACA, Flightradar24 on X. Times are publication or post times, Riyadh time.

CONFIRMED **Crown Prince Mohammed bin Salman receives French President Emmanuel Macron in Riyadh**

Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) / SPA · **5:23 PM** · published 5:23 PM AST Wed 21 Oct (Saudi state TV, translated from Arabic); SPA English 5:27 PM; checked 5:56 PM

Saudi state TV and SPA reported the Crown Prince receiving President Macron in Riyadh on Wednesday evening. Saudi Gazette reported at 5:29 PM that Macron pledged French military support against Houthi attacks; no French or Saudi text of that pledge was found yet.

CONFIRMED **Civil Defense urges caution as thunderstorms continue across most regions until Monday**

Saudi Civil Defense (@SaudiDCD) / SPA · **5:34 PM** · published 4:55 PM (SPA) and 5:34 PM AST Wed 21 Oct (translated from Arabic); checked 5:56 PM

Civil Defense says thunderstorms will continue over most of the Kingdom until next Monday and asks people to take care. Earlier, at 3:46 to 3:47 PM, it issued weather warnings for parts of the Makkah, Asir and Al Baha regions. This is a weather notice, not an attack warning.

CONFIRMED **Saudi state TV: Houthis block trucks with medicine, food and fuel from entering Taiz**

Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **5:03 PM** · published 5:03 PM AST Wed 21 Oct (Saudi state TV correspondent in Yemen, translated from Arabic); checked 5:56 PM

Al Ekhbariya's Yemen correspondent says the Houthis are stopping trucks carrying medical supplies, food and fuel from entering Taiz, and that more than 1.5 million residents are suffering under the siege, with hospitals appealing for help.

CONFIRMED **Riyadh airport account gives no reopening date, tells travellers to follow the authorities and their airline**

King Khalid International Airport (@KKIASA) · **4:58 PM** · reply posted 4:58 PM AST Wed 21 Oct to a traveller asking about the airport reopening; checked 5:56 PM

Asked for an update on the airport reopening, the official Riyadh airport account replied that travellers should follow the official competent authorities for airspace updates and contact the airline they booked with. It gave no date for scheduled flights to resume.

CONFIRMED **French President Macron lands at King Khalid International Airport, Riyadh**

SPA (@SPAregions) / Al Arabiya English · **4:23 PM** · SPA published 4:23 PM AST Wed 21 Oct; Al Arabiya English 4:33 PM named King Khalid International Airport; checked 5:56 PM

SPA and Al Ekhbariya said President Macron arrived in Riyadh and was met by the Deputy Governor of the Riyadh region; Al Arabiya English said the reception was at King Khalid International Airport. The state flight does not appear on the Flightradar24 airline boards, which still show no airline takeoff or landing at Riyadh since 3:02 AM.

CONFIRMED **Saudi and Jordanian foreign ministers sign amended coordination council protocol and review regional developments**

SPA (@SPAregions) / Al Ekhbariya · **4:11 PM** · SPA published 4:11 PM AST, Al Ekhbariya 4:28 PM Wed 21 Oct (translated from Arabic); checked 5:56 PM

Prince Faisal bin Farhan received Jordan's foreign minister in Riyadh and they signed an amended protocol for the Saudi-Jordanian Supreme Coordination Council chaired by the Crown Prince and the King of Jordan. Al Ekhbariya says they discussed regional events, led by the Houthis' continued strikes on Saudi territory.

UNVERIFIED **AP: Riyadh airport open to limited domestic traffic, with Saudia and flynas flying on Wednesday**

AP · **3:22 PM** · published 3:22 PM AST Wed 21 Oct, citing FlightAware; checked 5:56 PM

AP reports a limited number of Saudi airline flights took off and landed at Riyadh on Wednesday, two days after airlines were told they could resume with prior GACA permission (NOTAM A3650/26). The Flightradar24 boards we check show only the delayed Saudia SV982 departure at 3:02 AM and non-airline HZA8 today, so we cannot confirm a resumption.

CONFIRMED **Yemeni government forces repel a Houthi attack southeast of Taiz, killing and wounding dozens of militia fighters**

Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **12:16 PM** · published 12:16 PM AST Wed 21 Oct (Saudi state TV, translated from Arabic); checked 2:58 PM

Saudi state channel Al Ekhbariya reported that Yemeni forces repelled an attack by the Houthi militia southeast of Taiz, saying dozens of militia fighters were killed or wounded. No exact figures were given. This was inside Yemen, not on Saudi territory.

CONFIRMED **Yemen's central bank orders freeze of accounts and assets of 135 Houthi-linked people, entities and ships**

Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **10:28 AM** · published 10:28 AM AST Wed 21 Oct (Saudi state TV, translated from Arabic); checked 11:58 AM

Saudi state channel Al Ekhbariya reported that Yemen's central bank in Aden issued directives to freeze the accounts, funds and assets of 135 individuals, entities and vessels linked to the Houthi militia. No list of names was published in the post.

CONFIRMED **Coalition: another drone launched toward the Eastern Region intercepted and destroyed**

Coalition spokesman (@CJFCSpox) · **6:58 AM** · published 6:58 AM AST Wed 21 Oct (Arabic, translated); SPA English 7:18 AM; checked 8:56 AM

Coalition spokesman Maj. Gen. Turki Al-Malki said a further drone launched toward the Eastern Region was intercepted and destroyed, minutes after the four-drone announcement. No damage or casualties were reported.

CONFIRMED **Coalition: four drones launched toward Saudi Arabia intercepted and destroyed over the Madinah and Eastern regions**

Coalition spokesman (@CJFCSpox) · **6:52 AM** · published 6:52 AM AST Wed 21 Oct (Arabic, translated); SPA English 7:18 and 7:28 AM, also Al Ekhbariya, Arab News; checked 8:56 AM

The coalition said four drones launched toward the Kingdom were intercepted and destroyed, and that the interceptions took place in the Madinah and Eastern regions. It did not say who launched them or report any damage or casualties.

KING KHALID INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT · RIYADH

4 Riyadh airport: halted. No takeoff or landing since 9:29 PM (14184 min).

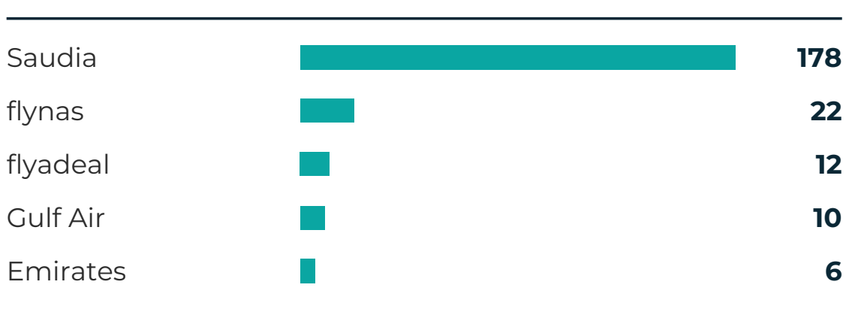
267	4:33 AM	1:59 PM	0	6
FLIGHTS CANCELLED TODAY	LAST TAKEOFF	LAST LANDING	TAKEOFFS, LAST HOUR	ARRIVALS DIVERTED
128 departures + 139 arrivals, 42% of 631 scheduled.	HZA8 to Heraklion (non-airline flight), 800 min before 5:53 PM. Last airline: SV982, 3:02 AM.	HZA8 from Heraklion, 234 min before 5:53 PM.	0 landings in the last hour.	Mostly to Jeddah, Dammam, Madinah.

***Cancellation basis:** Flightradar24 RUH board count, departures + arrivals scheduled on the local day (midnight to midnight, Riyadh time), all pages including flights still to come, codeshares and identical rows de-duplicated; boards fetched 5:53 PM. Flightradar24’s own stats panel shows 254 at 5:53 PM; the panel updates a few minutes behind the board.*

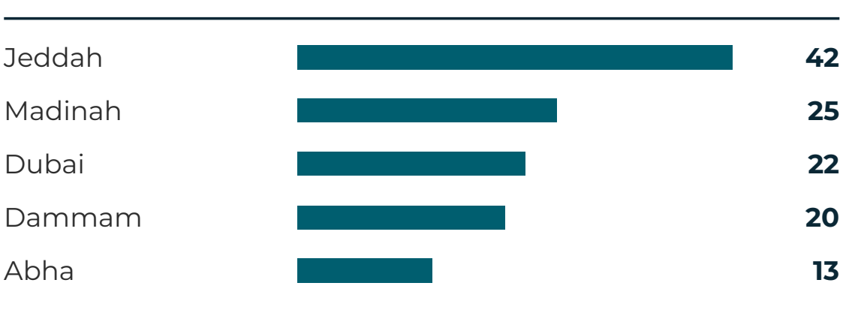
FLIGHTRADAR24 AIRPORT STATS

MEASURE	DEPARTURES	ARRIVALS	TOTAL	BASIS
Cancelled today, board count	**128**	**139**	**267**	FR24 boards, local day
Cancelled today, stats panel	**121 (38%)**	**133 (43%)**	**254**	FR24 stats panel
Delayed today	**3 (1%)**	**4 (1%)**	**7**	FR24 stats panel
On time today (share of operated)	**4 (57%)**	**3 (43%)**	**7**	FR24 stats panel
Average delay, recent flights	**0 min**	**0 min**	—	FR24 stats panel
Operated since midnight vs scheduled so far	**3 of 238**	**1 of 204**	**4 of 442**	FR24 boards
Diverted today	—	**6**	**6**	FR24 arrivals board
Already cancelled tomorrow	**38**	**38**	**76**	FR24 stats panel
Cancelled yesterday (for scale)	**175**	**180**	**355**	FR24 stats panel

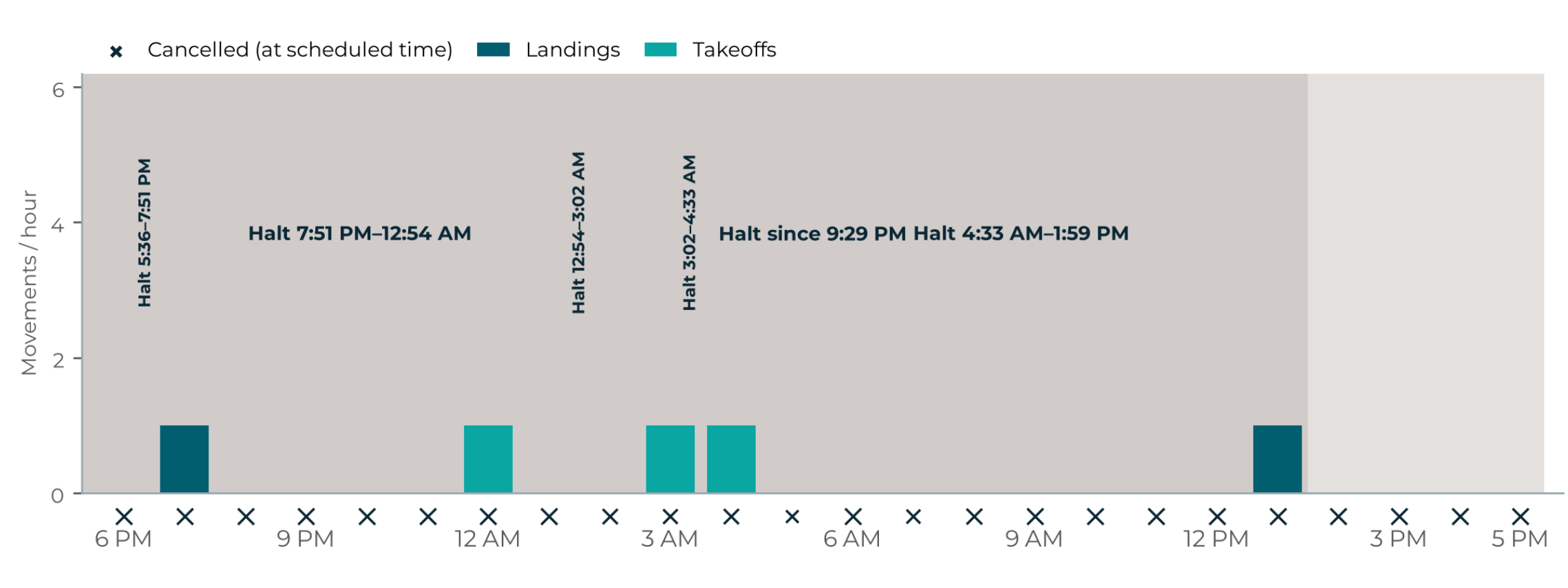
CANCELLATIONS BY AIRLINE, TOP 5



MOST-CANCELLED ROUTES, TOP 5



TAKEOFFS AND LANDINGS PER HOUR, LAST 24 HOURS · RUH



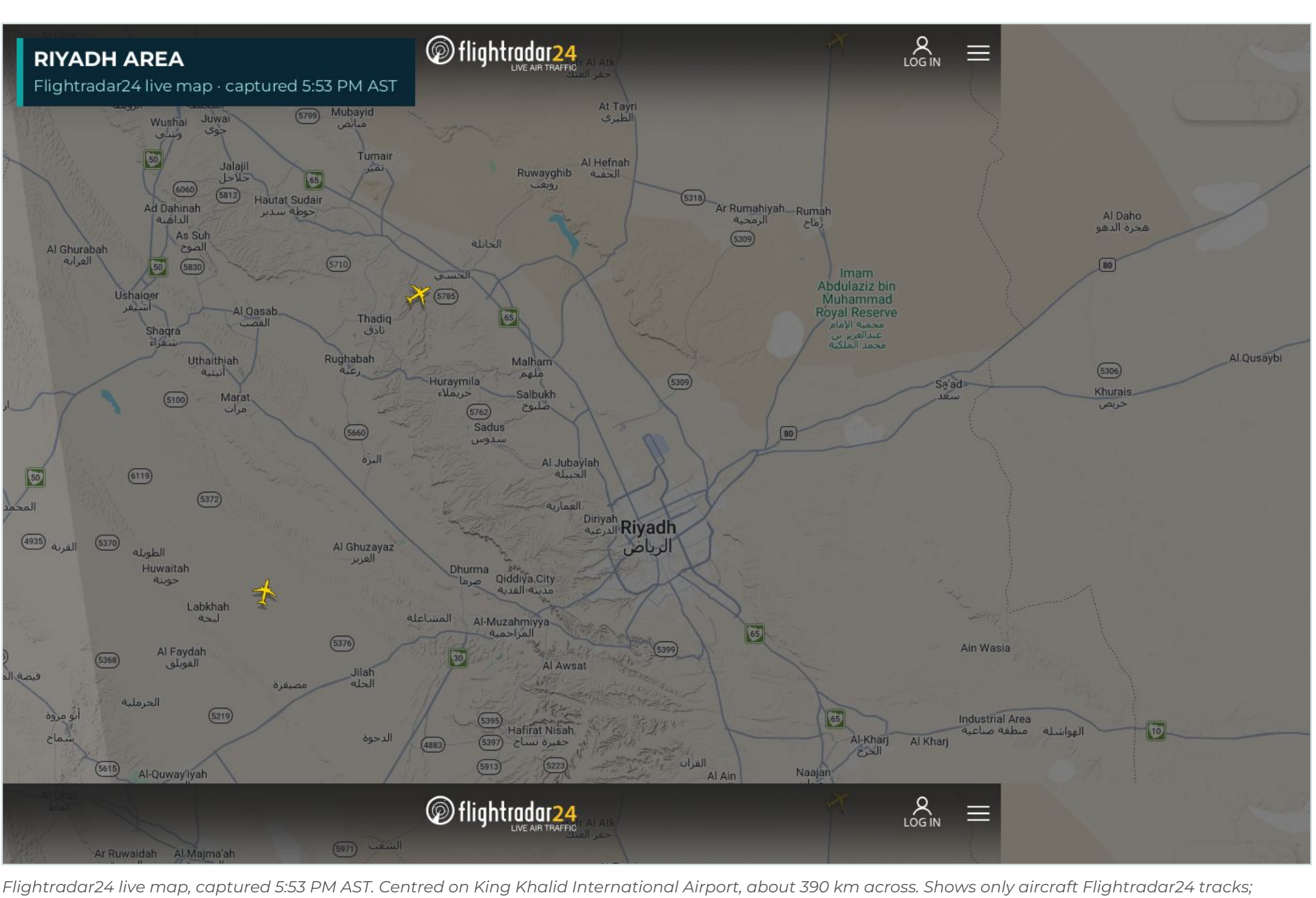
Recorded takeoffs (3) and landings (2) at RUH per hour from 6:00 PM Tuesday to 5:53 PM, Riyadh time; the newest bar is the current, partial hour. × marks flights cancelled, at their scheduled time. Gray boxes are halts: 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing on the board, kept until they roll out of the window. Source: Flightradar24 RUH departures and arrivals boards, fetched read-only.

Gray boxes mark halts of 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing, worked out from the Flightradar24 board and kept until they roll out of the 24-hour window. Riyadh’s open halt since 9:29 PM Sunday 11 Oct covers the whole window; the only Riyadh movements in it are delayed or non-scheduled flights: takeoffs HZSK5 to Geneva 11:05 AM and 0S2828 to Milan 5:36 PM Tuesday, Saudia SV992 12:54 AM, Saudia SV982 3:02 AM and HZA8 4:33 AM Wednesday, and the landing Saudia SV979 at 7:51 PM Tuesday. Dammam’s halts in the window ran 7:43–8:37 PM Tuesday, 1:45–2:55 AM, and 3:58–6:01 AM Wednesday (ended when Air Arabia G9161 took off).

HALTS IN THE LAST 24 HOURS

Halt 4:33 AM–1:59 PM	566 min
Halt 3:02–4:33 AM	91 min
Halt 12:54–3:02 AM	128 min
Halt 7:51 PM–12:54 AM	303 min
Halt 5:36–7:51 PM	135 min

AIRSPACE NOW · RIYADH AREA



Flightradar24 live map, captured 5:53 PM AST. Centred on King Khalid International Airport, about 390 km across. Shows only aircraft Flightradar24 tracks; military and transponder-off flights do not appear.

KING FAHD INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT · DAMMAM

5 Dammam airport: disrupted. 1 takeoff and 1 landing in the last hour.

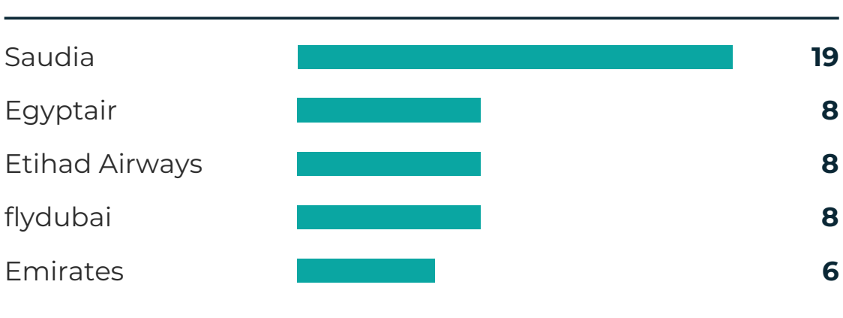
57	5:36 PM	5:33 PM	1	0
FLIGHTS CANCELLED TODAY	LAST TAKEOFF	LAST LANDING	TAKEOFFS, LAST HOUR	ARRIVALS DIVERTED
27 departures + 30 arrivals, 25% of 229 scheduled.	G9168 to Sharjah, 17 min before 5:53 PM.	XY420 from Jeddah, 20 min before 5:53 PM.	1 landings in the last hour.	None recorded today.

***Cancellation basis:** Flightradar24 DMM board count, departures + arrivals scheduled on the local day (midnight to midnight, Riyadh time), all pages including flights still to come, codeshares and identical rows de-duplicated; boards fetched 5:53 PM. Flightradar24’s own stats panel shows 54 at 5:54 PM; the panel updates a few minutes behind the board.*

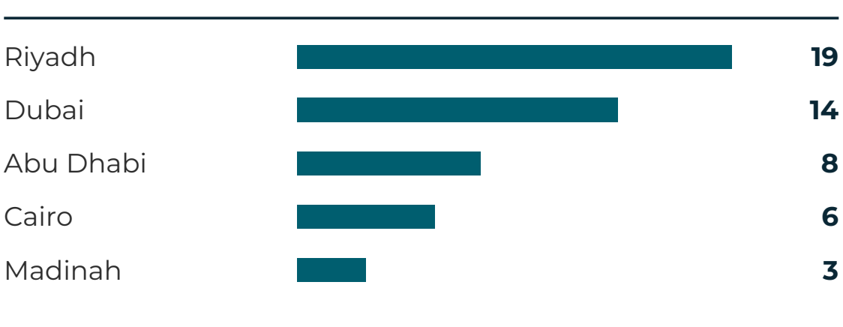
FLIGHTRADAR24 AIRPORT STATS

MEASURE	DEPARTURES	ARRIVALS	TOTAL	BASIS
Cancelled today, board count	**27**	**30**	**57**	FR24 boards, local day
Cancelled today, stats panel	**26 (22%)**	**28 (25%)**	**54**	FR24 stats panel
Delayed today	**11 (9%)**	**8 (7%)**	**19**	FR24 stats panel
On time today (share of operated)	**34 (76%)**	**28 (78%)**	**62**	FR24 stats panel
Average delay, recent flights	**4 min**	**5 min**	—	FR24 stats panel
Operated since midnight vs scheduled so far	**44 of 80**	**35 of 74**	**79 of 154**	FR24 boards
Diverted today	—	**0**	**0**	FR24 arrivals board
Already cancelled tomorrow	**12**	**10**	**22**	FR24 stats panel
Cancelled yesterday (for scale)	**32**	**32**	**64**	FR24 stats panel

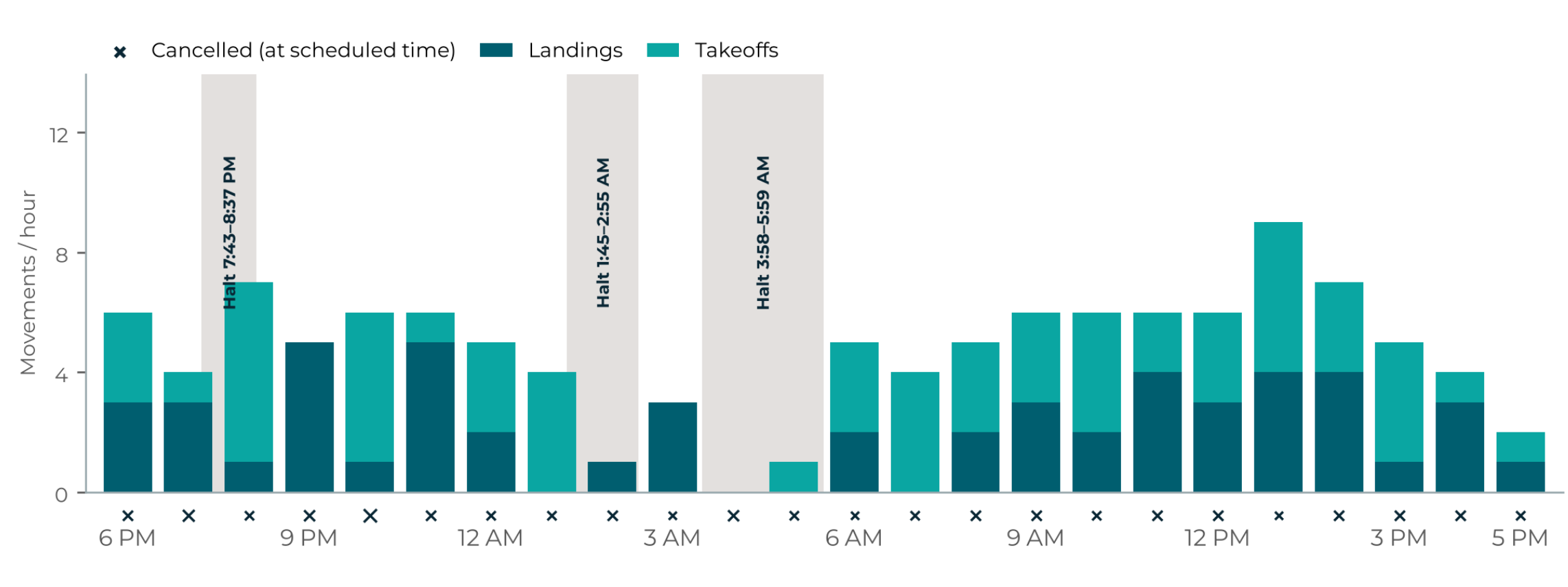
CANCELLATIONS BY AIRLINE, TOP 5



MOST-CANCELLED ROUTES, TOP 5



TAKEOFFS AND LANDINGS PER HOUR, LAST 24 HOURS · DMM



Recorded takeoffs (60) and landings (53) at DMM per hour from 6:00 PM Tuesday to 5:53 PM, Riyadh time; the newest bar is the current, partial hour. × marks flights cancelled, at their scheduled time. Gray boxes are halts: 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing on the board, kept until they roll out of the window. Source: Flightradar24 DMM departures and arrivals boards, fetched read-only.

Moving: 6 takeoffs and 5 landings since 3:00 PM, 1 takeoff and 1 landing in the last hour; no halt since 5:59 AM.

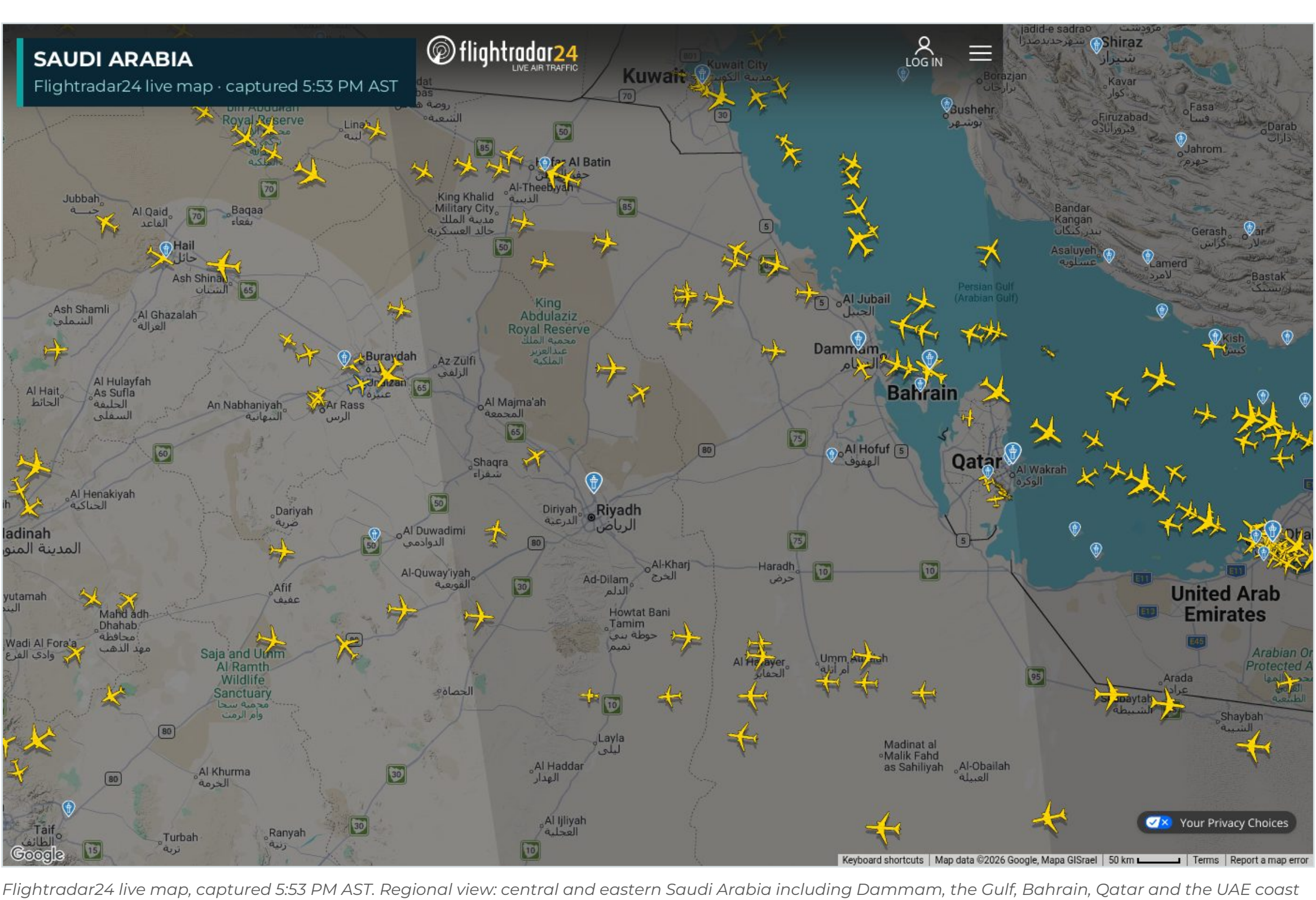
HALTS IN THE LAST 24 HOURS

Halt 3:58–5:59 AM	120 min
Halt 1:45–2:55 AM	70 min
Halt 7:43–8:37 PM	54 min

DAMMAM AIRPORT NEWS

No Dammam airport-specific statement or credible report found in this edition’s news check (5:56 PM).

AIRSPACE NOW · SAUDI ARABIA



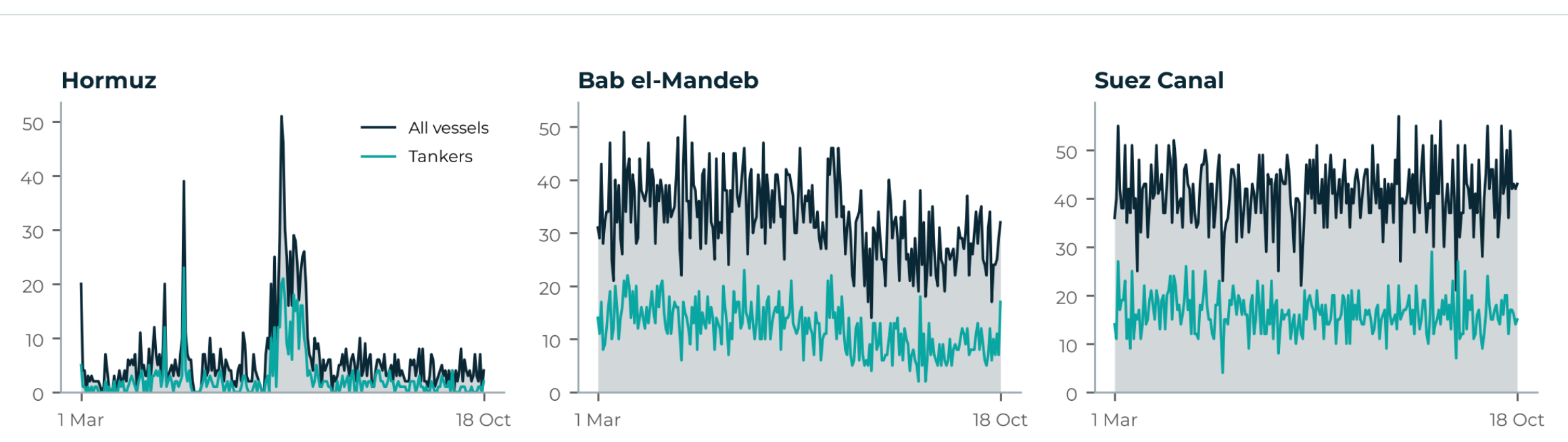
Flightradar24 live map, captured 5:53 PM AST. Regional view: central and eastern Saudi Arabia including Dammam, the Gulf, Bahrain, Qatar and the UAE coast (no Dammam-only view is captured). Shows only aircraft Flightradar24 tracks; military and transponder-off flights do not appear.

ECONOMY

6 Oil and shipping: Hormuz and Red Sea transits, Saudi crude exports, Brent crude.

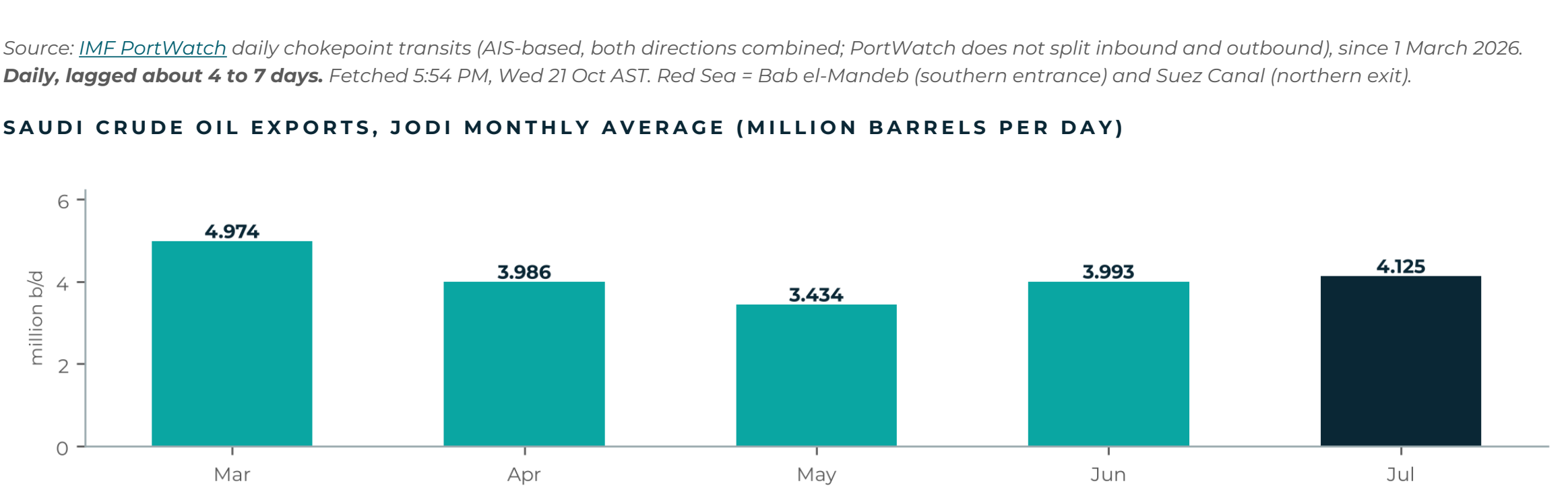
SHIPPING THROUGH HORMUZ AND THE RED SEA (IMF PORTWATCH, DAILY, LAGGED)

CHOKEPOINT	LATEST DAY	ALL VESSELS	TANKERS	OTHER SHIPS	7-DAY AVG (PRIOR 7)
Hormuz	Sun 18 Oct	**4**	2	2	3.7 (4.1)
Bab el-Mandeb	Sun 18 Oct	**32**	17	15	26.4 (28.3)
Suez Canal	Sun 18 Oct	**43**	15	28	44.3 (41.7)



*Source: IMF PortWatch daily chokepoint transits (AIS-based, both directions combined; PortWatch does not split inbound and outbound), since 1 March 2026. **Daily, lagged about 4 to 7 days.** Fetched 5:54 PM, Wed 21 Oct AST. Red Sea = Bab el-Mandeb (southern entrance) and Suez Canal (northern exit).*

SAUDI CRUDE OIL EXPORTS, JODI MONTHLY AVERAGE (MILLION BARRELS PER DAY)

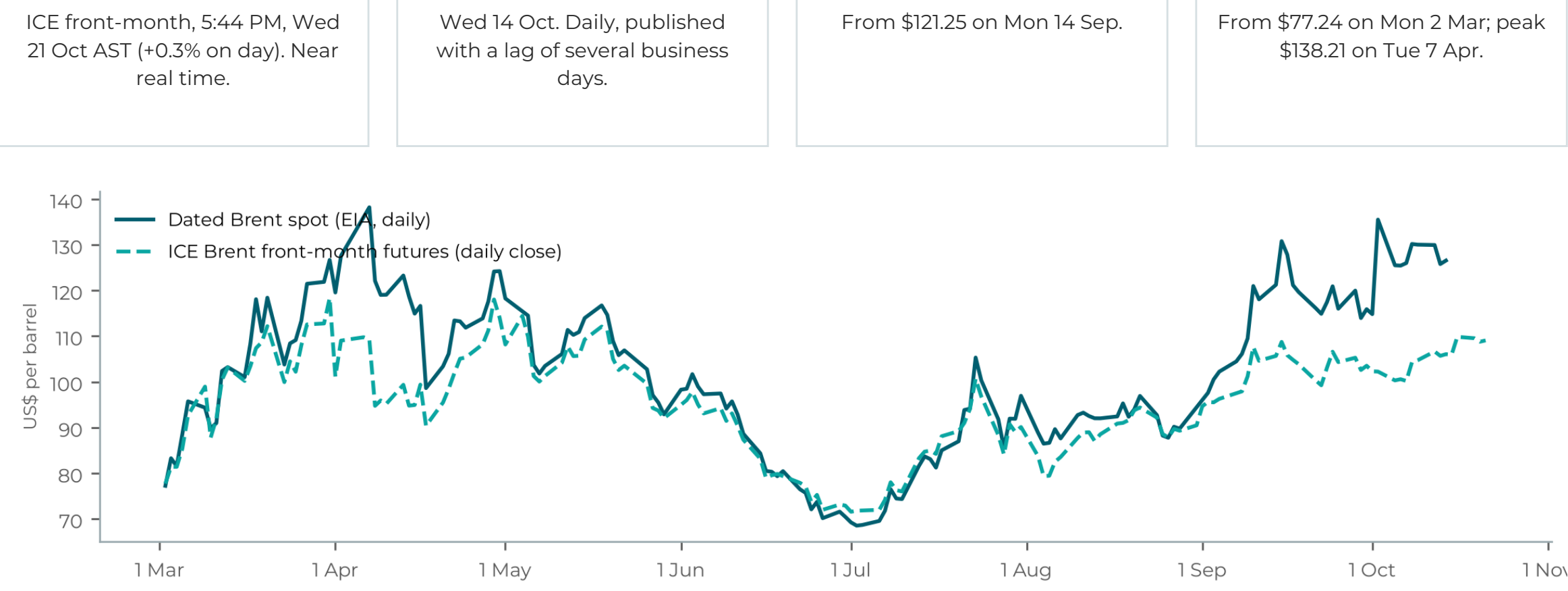


Monthly, lagged about two months. Saudi Arabia does not publish daily export figures and no free daily series exists; JODI is the finest official data. Latest month: July 2026, 4.12 million b/d. Daily cargo-level estimates need a paid tanker-tracking feed (Kpler, Vortexa).

Sources: JODI-Oil via Reuters: Mar (Reuters, 20 May) · Apr (Reuters, 21 Jul (revised from 3.990)) · May (Reuters, 21 Jul) · Jun (Reuters via BOE Report, 20 Aug) · Jul (Reuters via Zawya, 22 Sep).

BRENT CRUDE (US$ PER BARREL)

$109.07	$126.55	+4%	+64%
BRENT FUTURES, LATEST	DATED BRENT SPOT (EIA)	SPOT, 30-DAY CHANGE	SPOT, SINCE 1 MARCH
ICE front-month, 5:44 PM, Wed 21 Oct AST (+0.3% on day). Near real time.	Wed 14 Oct. Daily, published with a lag of several business days.	From $121.25 on Mon 14 Sep.	From $77.24 on Mon 2 Mar; peak $138.21 on Tue 7 Apr.



Sources: US EIA, Europe Brent Spot Price FOB (RBRTE), daily, official, lagged; ICE Brent futures (BZ=F) via Yahoo Finance, delayed quote; weekend values are Friday’s close. Physical Dated Brent has traded well above futures since the Gulf disruption, so the two lines differ.

METHOD AND LIMITS

7 What the numbers are, and are not.

- Airport figures (last takeoff and landing, counts, cancellations, diversions, charts, halts) come from the Flightradar24 RUH and DMM boards fetched at 5:53 PM, all pages for the local day. Flightradar24 is an unofficial aggregator, not a GACA or airport feed, and actual times can lag by a few minutes.
- Halts are computed per airport from the boards: any gap of 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing. Dammam’s status level is set automatically (halted if a halt is open; disrupted if 8%+ cancelled, 3+ diversions or a halt in the last 6 hours) unless set by hand.
- Escalation events come from strikes.json; each has a source link. Economy data are lagged: PortWatch by 4 to 7 days, JODI exports by about two months, EIA spot Brent by several business days; the Brent futures quote is near real time.
- Confidence tags: CONFIRMED = official statement made, or directly checked; CORROBORATED = multiple independent reports consistent with board data; UNVERIFIED = single or social reports not confirmed officially. Claims are attributed to their source.

PREPARED	BOARD DATA AS OF	SOURCES	STATUS	HANDLING	NEXT UPDATE
5:53 PM, Wed 21 Oct	5:53 PM	Flightradar24, GACA, AIS/NOTAC, Reuters, AP, AFP, BBC, Sabq, Gulf News, Arab News, SPA	**RUH Halted · DMM Disrupted**	Open sources · not official	9:00 PM

Sources: Flightradar24, IMF PortWatch, JODI, EIA, Reuters, AP, AFP, SPA · Check your airline · Next update 9:00 PM